RC-002 — Internal Announcement and Distribution Approval

Document control

Field	Value
Document ID	RC-002
Title	Internal Announcement and Distribution Approval
Version	2.4
Owner	Director, Internal Communications
Approver	Chief Communications Officer
Effective date	March 14, 2025
Review cycle	Annual
Audience	All workforce members
Classification	Internal

Document type: Memo from the Chief Communications Officer

TO: All workforce members

FROM: David Osei, Chief Communications Officer

DATE: March 14, 2025

SUBJECT: Updated standards for internal announcements and distribution lists

Team,

Over the past year, the volume of internal announcements has increased substantially. Feedback from the annual employee survey and from the last two town halls tells us that the volume is not matched by the usefulness. Many employees report that they have stopped reading company-wide announcements because most of them are not relevant to their role.

At the same time, we have heard from teams that important announcements sometimes go unseen because they are buried among announcements that are not relevant.

Starting April 1, 2025, the following standards apply to internal announcements and distribution lists. The goal is not to reduce communication — it is to make the communication that happens actually reach the people who need it.

1. What counts as an internal announcement

An internal announcement is any message sent to more than 50 employees, or to a distribution list that includes more than 50 employees, that communicates information not related to a specific project or team.

Announcements that go to a specific team, project, or group of fewer than 50 employees are not subject to this standard and can be sent by the team through their normal channel.

2. Approval requirements

Announcement type	Approval required
Company-wide (all employees)	Chief Communications Officer
Division-wide (all employees in a division)	Division leader plus Internal Communications
Department-wide (all employees in a department)	Department head
Targeted audience (50+ employees across teams)	Internal Communications
Crisis or emergency	Chief Communications Officer or delegate, with 30-minute turnaround

3. Submission timeline

Submit announcements to Internal Communications at least three business days before the requested send date. Same-day announcements are reserved for crises and time-sensitive operational issues.

Announcements requiring translation for non-English-speaking offices require five business days.

4. Content standards

Every internal announcement must include:

- Who it applies to. Be specific — "all employees in the US and Canada" is better than "all employees."
- What the reader needs to do. If there is no action, say so explicitly.
- When the deadline is, if any.
- Who to contact with questions.

Announcements without a contact person are returned.

5. Length and format

- Under 300 words: send as email
- 300–500 words: send as email with a linked longer version
- Over 500 words: send as a linked article with a short email teaser

Long announcements sent as email are poorly read. Linked articles are better read and better measured.

6. Frequency

Company-wide announcements are limited to two per week, sent on Tuesday and Thursday mornings. Exceptions are granted for urgent operational announcements at the Chief Communications Officer's discretion.

This limit exists because more than two per week causes readers to disengage. If we have more to communicate, we will consolidate or defer, not exceed the limit.

7. Distribution lists

Distribution lists are subject to the following rules:

- Company-wide lists (all employees) are maintained by IT and cannot be used by individual teams to send announcements
- Team, project, and group lists are maintained by the team, with the team lead as owner
- Lists with no owner are decommissioned on the annual review
- Lists that have not been used in 12 months are decommissioned
- Lists larger than 200 members require Internal Communications review before creation

A current list of approved distribution lists is maintained in the Communications team's intranet page.

8. Announcement archive

All approved announcements are archived for 3 years and are available in the intranet announcements archive. This allows employees to catch up on announcements they missed without needing to be re-sent.

9. Metrics

Internal Communications reports monthly to senior leadership on:

- Number of announcements sent
- Open rate by announcement
- Click-through rate for linked articles
- Number of announcements returned or deferred
- Employee feedback via the annual survey

These metrics are shared so that teams can see how their announcements perform.

10. What this is not

This is not a restriction on team communication. Teams continue to communicate with their own teams through their normal channels — meetings, chat, team emails. This standard applies to cross-team and company-wide communication.

11. Effective date

These standards are effective April 1, 2025. Announcements submitted before March 28 will be scheduled under the previous standards if they can be accommodated. After April 1, all announcements must follow these standards.

12. Questions

Questions about these standards should be directed to the Internal Communications team. Requests for exception should be directed to me.

David

Related documents

- RC-001 Records Retention, Legal Hold, and Disposal
- RC-003 Meeting Notes, Decisions, and Action Tracking
- SD-005 Customer Communication, Tone, and Status Update Guide

Revision history

Version	Date	Change
2.0	06/10/2023	Distribution list rules added
2.3	03-14-2024	Metrics section added
2.4	March 14, 2025	Frequency limit added; effective date set